

1848. Minimum Distance to the Target Element

Solved 

Easy

 Topics

 Companies

 Hint

Given an integer array `nums` (**0-indexed**) and two integers `target` and `start`, find an index `i` such that `nums[i] == target` and `abs(i - start)` is **minimized**. Note that `abs(x)` is the absolute value of `x`.

Return `abs(i - start)`.

It is **guaranteed** that `target` exists in `nums`.

Example 1:

Input: `nums = [1,2,3,4,5]`, `target = 5`, `start = 3`

Output: 1

Explanation: `nums[4] = 5` is the only value equal to `target`, so the answer is `abs(4 - 3) = 1`.

Example 2:

Input: `nums = [1]`, `target = 1`, `start = 0`

Output: 0

Explanation: `nums[0] = 1` is the only value equal to `target`, so the answer is `abs(0 - 0) = 0`.

Example 3:

Input: `nums = [1,1,1,1,1,1,1,1,1,1]`, `target = 1`, `start = 0`

Output: 0

Explanation: Every value of `nums` is 1, but `nums[0]` minimizes `abs(i - start)`, which is `abs(0 - 0) = 0`.

Constraints:

- `1 <= nums.length <= 1000`
- `1 <= nums[i] <= 104`
- `0 <= start < nums.length`
- `target` is in `nums`.

Python:

class Solution:

```
def getMinDistance(self, nums: list[int], target: int, start: int) -> int:
```

```
    result = len(nums)
```

```
    for i in range(len(nums)):
```

```
        if nums[i] == target:
```

```
            result = min(result, abs(i - start))
```

```
    return result
```

JavaScript:

```
var getMinDistance = function(nums, target, start) {
```

```
    const n = nums.length;
```

```
    for (let d = 0; d < n; d++) {
```

```
        if (start - d >= 0 && nums[start - d] === target)
```

```
            return d;
```

```
        if (start + d < n && nums[start + d] === target)
```

```
            return d;
```

```
    }
```

```
    return -1;
```

```
};
```

Java:

```
class Solution {
```

```
    public int getMinDistance(int[] nums, int target, int start) {
```

```
        int result = nums.length;
```

```
        for(int i = 0; i < nums.length; i++){
```

```
            if(nums[i] == target){
```

```
                result = Math.min(result, Math.abs(i - start));
```

```
            }
```

```
        }
```

```
        return result;
```

```
    }
```

```
}
```